Quarterly Project Debrief

The migration off the old database cluster finished two weeks ahead of schedule. Query latency on the new cluster is down by about forty percent during peak hours, and the team stopped seeing the nightly replication errors that used to page whoever was on call. There is still a backlog of stored procedures that need to be rewritten for the new engine, but nothing on that list is blocking a customer right now. Three new engineers started this month, two on the platform side and one focused on mobile. Onboarding took longer than usual because the internal documentation had drifted from what the infrastructure actually looks like today, so a chunk of the first week went into updating those pages instead of shipping code. The hiring pipeline for the designer role is still open after two rounds of interviews that did not land on a candidate. Support tickets this quarter cluster around the same complaint: the export feature times out on accounts with a lot of historical data. A handful of customers mentioned it directly on renewal calls, which is the clearest signal yet that it needs to move up the roadmap. Aside from that, satisfaction scores from the survey held steady compared to last quarter, with the biggest complaint being the mobile app's slow search results. The budget review pushed the hardware refresh into next quarter, which frees up enough room to backfill the designer role without asking finance for an exception. Cloud spend came in under forecast mainly because of the database migration mentioned earlier, since the new cluster runs on smaller instances for the same throughput. That saving is most of what is funding the extra headcount. Looking ahead, the plan is to finish the stored procedure rewrites before touching the export timeout issue, since some of the export logic depends on procedures that are already scheduled to change. Once that is done, the new engineers should be ramped up enough to take the export fix on as their first solo project, with one of the platform engineers reviewing the work.